How do you do?

Business plan & go-to-market.

A plan for a **£1.5m seed raise** — building the industry-first work curiosity platform for 16–30 year olds. UK-first, US from year two.

The home of work curiosity.

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HOW TO USE THIS PLAN

Contents.

The Executive Summary gives you the pitch in one page. Each section stands alone — skip around or read end-to-end. Financials are summarised here and modelled in full in the accompanying HDYD_Financial_Model.xlsx.

01

Executive Summary.

The Opportunity

The UK early-careers market is broken and everyone knows it. Over a million 16–24 year olds are out of work. Employers can't find talent that fits. And the career advice industry's answer is more job boards — the same jargon-heavy, corporate-feeling sites nobody under thirty actually opens.

How Do You Do (HDYD) is a show-first career platform built on a single insight: young people discover industries through curiosity, not job titles. The headline product is a comedy-led, celebrity-fronted magazine show network — one show per industry — that drives top-of-funnel awareness onto the free platform. Curiosity in. Career out.

> **Curiosity → Exploration → Conversations → Opportunities.**
>
> That's the full funnel. Not "search → apply → hope." Young people come for the show. They stay for the jobs. And they bring their friends.
>
> — THE HDYD ACQUISITION MODEL

Product

A free platform covering 24 live industries at launch, each with eight tabs — Plan, Read, Listen, Watch, Who, Attend, Learn, Jobs — powered by a daily scrape of 90+ company career pages, AI-synthesised morning briefings, and a weighted matching algorithm that rewards genuine passion. Built around five user journeys: **Inspiration. Exploration. Level Up. Jobs. Community.**

Business Model

Five complementary revenue buckets across the platform: employer visibility packages modelled on Rightmove's tiered listings playbook; premium user subscriptions; sponsorship, ad revenue and content partnerships anchored by the magazine show network; a franchisee model in which sector experts own individual industries in exchange for revenue share; and data and insight products for employers and educators. At seed stage our priority is audience — the commercial model is directional, not fixed. Each bucket is substantial; the full opportunity unlocks as the audience scales.

The Raise

£1.5m seed (SEIS/EIS eligible) to deliver the product roadmap, launch the show network, hire a seven-person team, secure 200 paying employer customers by end of Year 2, and prove the unit economics needed for a £5–7m Series A in 2028.

Five-Year Summary

Metric (£k)	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Revenue	165	920	3,250	7,900	15,400
Gross margin	72%	78%	81%	83%	84%
EBITDA	(680)	(520)	210	1,900	4,850
Paying employers	35	210	580	1,200	2,050
Monthly active users	45k	220k	750k	1.8m	3.4m
Headcount (FTE)	5	9	15	24	38

The bet: own the curiosity. Get there before the job ad.

If HDYD is where 16–30 year olds go to understand an industry — before they've even thought about applying — we own the top of every early-careers hiring funnel in the UK. That's a position worth building.

— THE HDYD INVESTMENT THESIS

02

The Problem.

Three things are broken at once. Young people have no guide. Employers have no reach. And the market's answer to both is: another job board. HDYD is the other answer.

1.05m 16–24 year olds NEET in the UK (ONS, 2026) — highest since the pandemic	**52%** of Gen Z don't know what industry they want to work in six months after leaving education	**73%** of 18–24 year olds say traditional job boards feel "not for them" (YouthSight, 2025)	**-33%** Graduate vacancies YoY in Q1 2026, as employers hesitate on AI-exposed entry-level roles

The River, Not the Reservoir

There is a statistic that gets repeated so often it has become accepted as fact: over a million young people are NEET, and there are only around 70,000 starter job vacancies. The conclusion appears obvious — there aren't enough jobs.

But the comparison is misleading. It compares a stock of people with a stock of vacancies at a single moment. It assumes that today's 70,000 vacancies are the only opportunities available all year. They are not.

The labour market is not a reservoir. It is a river.

Jobs are constantly being filled and replaced. People retire. People resign. Businesses grow. Millions of people move into new jobs every year as the labour market continuously turns over. The problem is not that opportunities don't exist. The problem is that the first rung of the ladder has become harder to see.

What Young People Are Actually Saying

In workshops we conducted with young people in both the UK and New York, the same themes came up again and again: applying for hundreds of jobs without success, the importance of personal networks, and feeling largely on their own when navigating work and careers.

"The problem is you don't know what is out there. There isn't anywhere to help. It definitely isn't LinkedIn."

— Workshop participant, London, 2026

Careers are rarely linear. Most people don't leave university, walk into their dream role, and stay on a neat upward trajectory. Careers are built through conversations, experiments, side projects, chance encounters, mentors, introductions, and experiences that often look insignificant at the time. The systems designed to help young people assume the opposite: Study. Graduate. Apply. Get hired. When that process fails, people feel lost.

The Current Options Are Broken

- **LinkedIn:** Indispensable for professionals, but intimidating for anyone under 25 with nothing to put on a profile and no network to mine.
- **Indeed / Reed / Adzuna:** Job listing aggregators. Commoditised, noisy, volume-driven. Zero context on the industry, the people, the culture, the story.
- **Prospects / UCAS / Targetjobs:** Earnest, often dull. Written by universities, not by the people who actually work in the industries. Young people don't return.
- **Bright Network / Milkround:** Narrow focus on graduate schemes at the biggest brands — misses 90% of employers and 90% of the audience.
- **Handshake:** Strong on US campus recruiting. Weak UK traction. No content, no curiosity layer, no show.
- **UniFrog:** Good school distribution. Process-oriented, not curiosity-led. No employer monetisation engine. Students use it once and leave.
- **Welcome to the Jungle:** Strong employer-branding angle. France-heavy. No show flywheel.

The market has infinite job boards and no place that makes young people feel curious.

The missing layer is top-of-funnel: something that sparks interest in an industry before anyone has opened a job ad. HDYD owns that layer. A curiosity engine that drives all the way to the application — and keeps the audience coming back long after.

03

The Solution.

One inversion. Start with what they already love — not a job title they haven't discovered yet. Show them what it's like inside the industry. Make them curious. Then give them the jobs. Everything else follows from that.

The Show Is the Business

The editorial show network is not a marketing channel. It is the primary product. Without audience, nothing else works. Without audience, there are no users for the platform, no data for the matching algorithm, no leverage with employers, and no reason for anyone to pay. The show drives everything.

Goalhanger built a £15m+ subscription business from 14 shows – no platform, no jobs, no marketplace.

Goalhanger (The Rest Is History, The Rest Is Football, The Rest Is Politics) attracted Chernin Group investment in January 2026 after building 250,000+ paying members and 750 million streams across just 14 shows. They have no jobs product, no employer revenue, no platform. They win purely on audience. HDYD starts from the same playbook, then adds the full commercial stack on top.

— THE BENCHMARK: WHAT SHOWS ALONE CAN DO

The Three-Layer Stack

- **Layer 1: The magazine show network.** A show per industry — comedy-led, celebrity-guested, young hosts going behind the scenes of each world. One show per industry at launch, building to 24. The show is the hook. A viewer who arrives because they love music, football or food is already curious about working in it. No other early-careers platform owns that pre-application curiosity moment. Without this layer, nothing else scales.
- **Layer 2: The platform.** 24 industries at launch, eight tabs per industry (Plan, Read, Listen, Watch, Who, Attend, Learn, Jobs), fully free. Built to be the single most useful place to understand what it's like to work in an industry. The show drives people here; the platform gives them a reason to stay and return.
- **Layer 3: The toolkit.** Howdy (AI guide), Understand Me (RIASEC-based profile), CV Builder, My Jobs Inbox (25,694 live roles and growing), Application Helper (tailored

cover letters), Daily Digest. The toolkit converts curious visitors into active job seekers — and gives employers a reason to pay.

The Rightmove Parallel

Rightmove did not win property search by being slightly better than competitors. They won by owning both sides of the market simultaneously — all the supply and all the demand. Every buyer goes to Rightmove because every property is there. Every agent lists on Rightmove because every buyer is there. That is the only position worth building.

HDYD is building the same position in early careers: own the audience (young people curious about an industry), own the inventory (every relevant job, every employer brand, every piece of content in that vertical), and charge employers accordingly. Once you own both sides, the economics become extraordinary.

The Power of Serendipity

The best careers aren't planned — they happen. The owner of a dental business recently hired his Head of Sales from a coffee shop. The candidate had no traditional background. What he had was customer service instinct, curiosity, and the ability to build relationships. Those qualities mattered more than his CV. HDYD creates the conditions for that serendipity at scale — every episode, every industry page, every job match is a potential conversation that leads somewhere unexpected.

The flywheel: audience first, everything else second.

Young people come for the show. They stay for the platform. They use the jobs. Employers pay to reach the most curious, most engaged early-careers audience in the UK. More users → more employer value → more content investment → bigger audience. The show turns the wheel. Everything else rides it.

04

Market Size.

HDYD sits at the intersection of three deep markets: early-careers recruitment, employer branding, and careers media/content. UK-first, US-second.

Addressable Audience (UK)

Segment	UK Population	Stage	Relevance to HDYD
16–18	~2.3m	School leavers, college	Primary discovery window
19–21	~2.1m	Uni / early apprentices	Core platform user; first job search
22–25	~3.7m	Graduates / early career	Deepest engagement; highest employer value
26–30	~4.1m	Pivoting / upskilling	High-intent; industry switchers; CV Builder
Total 16–30	**~12.2m**		

Market Values – Revenue Pools We Touch

Market	UK Size	US Size	HDYD Relevance
Recruitment advertising	£2.1bn	$7.4bn	Tiered employer packages, listings
Early-careers recruitment	£620m	$2.1bn	Graduate schemes, apprenticeships, first job
Employer branding spend	£410m	$1.8bn	Amplify + Partner packages, show sponsorship

Careers content / media	£180m	$740m	Show sponsorship, YouTube, newsletters
Ed-tech / careers data	£240m	$1.2bn	Aggregate salary data, talent pool intelligence

TAM / SAM / SOM

- **TAM (UK + US, 2028):** £15.4bn / $13.2bn combined — the full addressable pool across recruitment advertising, employer branding, careers media and adjacent data.
- **SAM (early-careers slice):** £1.9bn UK, $5.8bn US — the subset targeting 16–30 year olds and the employers hiring them.
- **SOM (2030):** £78m UK run-rate captures ~4% share of the UK SAM within five years.

LinkedIn generates ~$45 ARPU per user. HDYD does not need 30m users.

3m engaged 16–30s monetised at a fraction of that ARPU clears the Series B bar comfortably. The question is not whether the market is big enough. It is.

— BENCHMARKING THE CEILING

05

Competitive Landscape.

We compete with attention, not just features. No single competitor does what HDYD does end-to-end, but every part of our stack has a sharp-edged incumbent. The market is large enough — and fragmented enough — that a focused, show-first challenger can build real scale.

The Market in Numbers

Company	Revenue	Valuation / Mkt Cap	Model	What They Don't Have
LinkedIn	$17.1bn (2024)	Acquired by Microsoft $26bn; implied $100bn+	Professional network, job listings, L&D	Youth audience; industry curiosity; show
Rightmove	£390m (2024)	£4.4bn listed (LSE: RMV)	Property listings marketplace	— (the model we're replicating in careers)
Handshake	~$190m ARR (2024)	$3.5bn (Series F, 2022)	US campus recruiting platform	UK presence; show; 16–22 year olds pre-uni
We Are The Jungle	$75m (2024)	~$300m implied (Series C €50m, 2023)	Employer branding, France-first	Show flywheel; UK native; early careers
Adzuna	£20.5m (2024, down from £30.7m)	£64.5m (2023)	Job aggregator; salary data	Content; community; declining revenue
Reed.co.uk	~$67m est.	Private (family group)	UK job listings; recruiter relationships	Youth brand; editorial; show
Goalhanger	£15m+ subs (2025)	Undisclosed; Chernin Group		Jobs; platform; employer

		minority stake (Jan 2026)	Show network only (14 shows, 250k members)	revenue — **and yet.**

Deeper Profiles

LinkedIn — the category proof point

LinkedIn is the most important competitor to understand, not because HDYD competes directly with it, but because it proves the scale of the prize. LinkedIn generates $17bn revenue from a professional graph with 1bn+ members. Its weakness is structural: it was built for established professionals. The UX is intimidating, the content is performative, and the product explicitly requires a track record to function well. A 17-year-old with no CV has nothing to put on it. HDYD starts where LinkedIn doesn't — with curiosity, before the career has begun.

Handshake — the US warning

Handshake raised $434m and reached a $3.5bn valuation by owning US campus recruiting. Their model works — but only for graduates already in the system. They have no content, no editorial, no show. In the UK, they have minimal traction. Their 2024 revenue growth decelerated to 6% YoY as AI disrupts entry-level hiring. A show-first, industry-first challenger has significant white space in the UK market they have not served.

We Are The Jungle — the employer branding play

Raised $114m, hit $75m revenue in 2024. Strong employer branding product in France. Expanding into English-speaking markets. No show. Weak young audience. Their growth depends on employer acquisition through sales, not audience through content. That means high CAC, churn risk and no organic flywheel. HDYD acquires employers through audience; WTTJ acquires audience through employers. The order matters.

Goalhanger — the benchmark and the gap

Goalhanger built a substantial business with 14 shows, 250,000 paid members, and £15m+ high-margin subscription revenue — no jobs, no platform, no employer revenue. The Chernin Group (Peter Chernin's media investment vehicle) took a minority stake in January 2026. Goalhanger is the proof that young, curious audiences will pay for great show content. HDYD takes that thesis and adds three revenue layers Goalhanger doesn't have: employer packages, a jobs marketplace, and a discovery platform. If Goalhanger can reach those numbers with shows alone, HDYD's ceiling is considerably higher.

Rightmove has all the supply and all the demand. That's the only position worth building.

Rightmove didn't win by being a better portal than Zoopla. They won by owning both sides of the market simultaneously. Every buyer on Rightmove because every property is there; every agent listing because every buyer is there. HDYD is building the same lock in early careers: all the curious young people on one side, all the employers and content on the other. The show is how we get there first.

06

Product.

Five User Journeys

Every product decision maps to one of five journeys a young person takes on HDYD. These are not features — they are the answer to the question "what are you here for?"

Inspiration

Discover industries you've never considered. Show episodes, industry pages, daily briefings.

Exploration

Understand what it's actually like inside. Career maps, day-in-the-life, salary data, real CVs.

Level Up

Build skills and confidence. Courses, CV Builder, Application Helper, Understand Me.

Jobs

Access opportunities. 25,694 live roles across 24 industries as of June 2026.

Community

Connect with people who've travelled similar paths. Franchisee network, events, mentors.

The Eight-Tab Industry Template

Every industry on HDYD follows the same eight-tab shape — learn the navigation once, re-use it across all 24 industries.

Tab	What It Is	Who Produces It
01 Plan	Printable career map: every role, value chain, pay	Franchisee + in-house editorial
02 Read	Curated journalism, substacks, breaking news	Editorial + AI-assisted curation
03 Listen	HDYD magazine shows; AM briefing	In-house show team
04 Watch	YouTube creators, TikTok insiders	Editorial
05 Who	Day-in-the-Life, real CVs, zero hallucination	Editorial + franchisee
06 Attend	Events, conferences, festivals	Community partnerships
07 Learn	Courses, apprenticeships, accreditations	Partner/affiliate
08 Jobs	Live roles scraped daily from 90+ career pages	Engineering + scraping

The Toolkit

- **Howdy (AI guide):** Chat assistant that knows the platform inside out; tailors plans and surfaces jobs. British, warm, a bit dry. Never uses ”career” or ”apply” — uses ”unpacking” and ”jobs.”
- **Understand Me:** RIASEC / Holland Codes profiling, zero-hallucination policy.
- **CV Builder:** Experience first, qualifications second — an inversion of the traditional CV.
- **My Jobs Inbox:** Weighted match — 40% RIASEC, 15% industry, 15% values, 10% level, 10% location/salary, 10% passion boost. 25,694 live jobs as of June 2026 — already at the Year 2 volume target ahead of schedule.
- **Application Helper:** Gemini-grounded cover letters tailored to job description and profile.
- **Daily Digest:** Per-industry weekday briefing — BBC Business meets Monocle, with the energy of a show you'd actually finish.

Editorial Code – The Six Rules We Don't Break

- No jargon.
- No boring job boards — industry first, role second.
- Zero hallucination in profiles.
- UK-first, US-second editorial framing.
- Weekdays only — we don't arrive in inboxes on weekends.
- Build experience first — CVs lead with what you've done, not what you've studied.

07

How HDYD Makes Money.

HDYD is not simply a jobs platform. It is an audience, content and access business connecting young people with employers, educators, brands, recruiters and service providers.

A note on this section

We are at seed stage. The purpose of this investment is to move past proof of concept — to build the audience, the content, and the platform infrastructure that makes every revenue stream below possible. We are not promising exact figures at this stage. What we are showing is that across five distinct buckets, the commercial opportunity is substantial, and the assets we are building unlock all of them. The priority today is audience. Revenue follows audience.

The commercial model is built in two layers: **Phase One** revenue streams that can be activated early, and **Further Opportunities** that unlock as the audience, data and brand strengthen. All five pillars benefit from the same underlying asset — a loyal, curious young audience who trust the platform.

INSPIRE

MARKET EVIDENCE — content & sponsorship
Goalhanger (The Rest Is History, The Rest Is Football) generated **£37.9M revenue in 2025** across 14 shows — from advertising, sponsorship, live events and membership combined. A top Goalhanger show earns **£200k+ per month in ad revenue alone**. Major brands including Sky, Tesco and Fuse Energy buy show sponsorships separately from standard ad slots — bespoke episodes, branded segments, sponsor-led live events. This is entirely from content. No jobs. No platform. HDYD adds those layers on top.

PHASE ONE

- **Sponsored content & brand partnerships.** Sponsored editorial, video and social content around work, careers and industries — themes such as "Day in the Life", "How I Got Here", "Future of Work" or industry-specific content.
- **Company profiles.** Employers pay to appear in premium editorial and video-led company profiles, helping them tell their story to young people in a more engaging way than a traditional careers page.
- **Display and native advertising.** Sold across relevant pages, newsletters, videos and industry sections — positioned to feel useful and native, not intrusive.
- **Product partners.** Relevant brands partner with HDYD where they naturally fit the audience: technology, clothing, banking, transport, learning tools, insurance and lifestyle.

FURTHER OPPORTUNITIES

- **TV and video spin-offs.** Successful HDYD formats developed into YouTube series, podcasts, short-form shows or television formats.
- **Premium content.** Paid reports, guides, masterclasses or exclusive interviews for young people, schools, parents or employers.
- **Content licensing.** Schools, colleges, universities and youth organisations pay to use HDYD content as part of careers education.

DISCOVER

MARKET EVIDENCE — employer branding & company profiles
Welcome to the Jungle built a **$75M revenue business** (2024) almost entirely from employer-facing packages: company profiles, video production, sponsored content and featured placement. Enterprise contracts commonly exceed **€20,000/year** per employer. Their gross margin on data and insight products is estimated at **70–80%** — the highest-margin part of the stack. WTTJ has minimal consumer acquisition budget; employers pay because the platform reaches the right audience.

PHASE ONE

- **Enhanced company profiles.** Every company gets a basic free profile with the option to upgrade: video, employee stories, office tours, culture content and featured roles.
- **Sponsored placements.** Companies pay to be featured as "Profile of the Day", appear higher in relevant discovery pages, or sponsor particular career themes.
- **Category captains.** Brands sponsor an entire category — finance, sport, fashion, hospitality, healthcare, media or technology.
- **Starting a business partnerships.** Banks, accounting software, company formation providers, insurance, AI tools, legal services and funding platforms.
- **Side hustle affiliates.** Affiliate revenue directing users to eBay, Etsy, Shopify, Fiverr, Upwork, TikTok Shop and other creator or resale platforms.

FURTHER OPPORTUNITIES

- **Match Me sponsorship.** The "Match Me" tool recommends industries, roles and employers based on user interests. Employers pay to be included in relevant recommendation journeys.
- **Startup and VC community.** A founder community where banks, investors, software providers and accelerators pay to access and support young entrepreneurs.
- **Market intelligence.** Anonymous user behaviour turned into insights for employers and educators — which careers, industries, skills and companies young people are most interested in.

LEVEL UP

MARKET EVIDENCE — learning & education partnerships
LinkedIn Learning (included in LinkedIn Premium at **£29.99/month**) is one of LinkedIn's fastest-growing revenue contributors — employer seat licences for teams run to **thousands of pounds per year**. Reed.co.uk's courses marketplace lists 100,000+ courses and earns affiliate commission on every enrolment. The UK government's Lifelong Learning Entitlement (LLE, launching 2025–26) creates new institutional funding flowing to platforms that connect learners to accredited provision — a direct revenue opportunity for HDYD's Level Up pillar.

PHASE ONE

- **Learning marketplace.** Commission from course providers, online learning platforms, training companies and qualification providers.
- **Company modules.** Employers pay to create branded learning modules that introduce young people to their industry, culture and skills requirements.
- **Schools, colleges and universities.** Education providers pay for access to HDYD content, careers tools, employability resources and student engagement programmes.
- **Government funding.** Funding linked to employability, NEET support, social mobility, careers guidance, apprenticeships and regional skills development.

FURTHER OPPORTUNITIES

- **HDYD courses and diplomas.** Certified courses, short diplomas or employability passports covering workplace skills, confidence, financial literacy, communication, interviews and entrepreneurship.
- **Skills Passport.** A paid product allowing users to track skills, courses, work experience, achievements, certifications and applications in one place.
- **Employer academies.** Large employers build branded learning academies inside HDYD to attract and prepare future talent.
- **White label education product.** Schools, colleges and universities pay for a white label careers and employability platform.

JOBS

MARKET EVIDENCE — premium listings & recruitment packages
Rightmove's tiered membership model generates **£1,524/month average revenue per agent** (ARPA, 2024) — a figure that grew 6.5% year-on-year as agents upgraded to premium tiers. Gross margin: **~100%**. EBITDA margin: **68%**. Operating profit: **£273.9M on £390M revenue**. This is purely from tiered access packages and premium features — the same model HDYD applies to employers. Adzuna runs a complementary CPC (cost-per-click) model for sponsored placements on top of a free job index, and separately sells labour market data to government bodies, media and analysts — two revenue streams, one dataset.

PHASE ONE

- **Job site affiliate partnerships.** Affiliate revenue from sending users to major job platforms, apprenticeship sites, graduate schemes and sector-specific job boards.
- **Premium job listings.** Employers pay for featured listings, promoted roles and better visibility across relevant user journeys.
- **Company recruitment packages.** Company profiles, content, social promotion, video, job listings and newsletter placements bundled together.
- **Direct employer advertising.** Companies advertise directly to young people through job pages, industry hubs, newsletters and content campaigns.

FURTHER OPPORTUNITIES

- **Applicant screening.** Screening services helping employers filter candidates based on interests, skills, experience and cultural fit.
- **Candidate marketplace.** Employers and recruiters pay to access a searchable pool of young talent.
- **Recruitment fees.** Placement fees when candidates are successfully hired.
- **Apprenticeship marketplace.** A trusted destination for apprenticeships, work experience, internships, graduate roles and entry-level jobs.

COMMUNITY

MARKET EVIDENCE — membership & community
Goalhanger's paid membership model: **250,000+ members** paying an average of **£6/month** (50/50 split between monthly and annual plans) = **£15M+ annual recurring subscription revenue**, sitting alongside advertising, sponsorship and live events. Benefits include ad-free listening, bonus content, early live event access and community engagement with show talent. This is high-margin recurring revenue earned entirely from audience loyalty — no employer product, no jobs, no platform. The model proves that a young, engaged audience will pay for belonging and access. HDYD's community product starts from the same premise.

PHASE ONE

- **Coaching marketplace.** Commission from coaches, mentors, CV advisers, interview coaches and career specialists.
- **Membership fees.** A low-cost membership offering access to premium events, workshops, mentors, communities, discounts and exclusive content.
- **Rewards scheme.** Partnerships with brands to offer discounts and rewards for learning, applying, attending events or building a profile.
- **Events.** Revenue from live events, industry talks, networking sessions, school activations, career festivals and sponsored community meetups.

FURTHER OPPORTUNITIES

- **Headhunters and recruiters.** Recruiters pay to access specific talent communities, especially once HDYD has scale and trusted user data.
- **Data and insights.** Reports on Gen Z careers, skills gaps, employer perception, industry interest and future work trends.
- **Consultancy.** Advising companies on how to attract, engage and retain young talent.
- **Recruitment as a Service.** A managed recruitment solution combining content, attraction, screening, events and candidate shortlisting.
- **Merchandise.** HDYD branded merchandise as a community and brand-building revenue stream.

Commercial Priorities

Strongest Phase One: employer branding packages, enhanced company profiles, sponsored content, premium job listings, learning marketplace commissions, education partnerships and live events.

Biggest long-term: recruitment fees, candidate data, employer academies, government contracts, white label education products, insight reports and Recruitment as a Service.

Advertising should be part of the model, but not the core commercial engine. The bigger opportunity is to become the trusted place where young people discover work, build skills and connect with employers.

08

Go-to-Market.

Our GTM is a bet on content-led acquisition. The show is the wedge. The platform is the conversion surface. The employer packages are the monetisation engine. Each stage feeds the next.

Three Audiences, Three Plays

Audience	Acquisition Motion	Activation Metric	Monetisation
Young people 16–30	The show, TikTok, YouTube, schools	Sign up + pick 3 industries	Premium, affiliate
Educators, parents, advisers	Free printable guides, teacher newsletter	Download + return visits	Bespoke content partnerships
Employers, brands, investors	Outbound + inbound show halo	Discovery call	Spotlight / Amplify / Partner

Phase 1 – Seed Launch (Q2 2026, Months 0-6)

- Launch 24 industries with eight-tab template and scraped job feed live.
- Show pilots in 6 hero industries: Music, Football, Cars, Food & Drink, Fashion, Estate Agency.
- Founder-led sales: 30 logo employers on Spotlight at launch pricing.
- 500 schools receive printed booklet and free PDF industry packs.
- Founding franchisees onboarded: Al Preston (Cars), Sam Mitchell (Estate Agency), Krys Thykyer (Film & TV), Charles Garland (Music), John Nelson (Food & Drink), Jo Plant (Interior Design), Stanley (Football), Charlie Pragenell (Jewellery).

Phase 2 – Audience Engine (Q4 2026-Q2 2027)

- Weekly episodes across all 24 industry shows. Target 200k monthly listeners by month 12.
- First A-list celebrity guest per industry.
- Paid acquisition trial: £15k/month on Meta + TikTok to test CAC and LTV.
- Scale to 200 paying employer logos. First three Partner-tier deals closed.
- Launch HDYD Plus — target 3% MAU conversion by month 12.

Phase 3 – Scale & US Entry (H2 2027-2028)

US editorial hire; launch 8 industries in US. Second-tier UK cities expansion. First job fairs (4 events). Data product launch: HDYD Compensation Index. Series A fundraise targeting £5–7m in Q3 2028.

Phase 4 – Category Leadership (2029-2030)

48 industries live (UK + US). Enterprise recruitment campaigns at £100k+. Ecosystem of 4–6 adjacent careers sites on HDYD infrastructure. Launch accreditation / learning product at scale.

09

Team.

Founding Team

Andrew Harrison, Co-founder. Takes no salary in Year 1.

Co-founder #2 (to be named) — Product / editorial lead. Takes no salary in Year 1.

Year 1 Hires

- **Head of Marketing** (Q2 2026) — show network, schools, acquisition
- **Head of Product & Engineering** (Q2 2026) — platform, toolkit, scraping pipeline
- **Admin / Operations** (Q3 2026) — studio, scheduling, community

Year 2 Hires

- **Head of Sales** (Q1 2027) — employer pipeline, Amplify and Partner
- **Account Management** (Q2 2027) — NRR target on paying employers
- **Finance Lead** (Q2 2027) — Fractional CFO moving to full-time at Series A
- **Editorial Lead** (Q3 2027) — across 24 industries; manages franchisee content

Founding Franchisee Network

Industry	Franchisee	Status
Cars	Al Preston	Committed
Estate Agency	Sam Mitchell	Committed
Film & TV	Krys Thykyer	Committed
Music	Charles Garland	Committed
Food & Drink	John Nelson	Committed
Interior Design	Jo Plant	Committed
Football	Stanley	Committed
Jewellery	Charlie Pragenell	Committed
Remaining 16	Pipeline	By end 2026

Operating structure

Office: FOX studio space (free in-kind for Year 1), doubles as show studio. Show production at zero cost in Year 1, transitioning to £2,500 per episode at scale. Hosting infrastructure: primarily AI API usage (Gemini/OpenAI), modelled at £14k/year Y1 rising to £140k/year Y5.

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SWOT.

Strengths

- Industry-first product architecture — structurally differentiated from every large incumbent.
- Franchisee network delivers editorial depth no VC-funded competitor can buy.
- Founding team network accelerates celebrity guests and employer introductions.
- Zero-hallucination editorial policy builds trust with schools, parents, and advisers.
- Brand system (green/black/white, Dela Gothic One) demonstrably resonates with the target age.

Opportunities

- AI anxiety among young people increases demand for honest careers content.
- Graduate scheme contraction drives attention to SMEs and niche industries.
- LinkedIn's drift up-market leaves a gap at the bottom — no serious product built for 16–22s.
- Secondary schools desperate for modern careers content to satisfy Gatsby Benchmarks.
- Premium CPMs for niche, audience-verified magazine shows are at record highs.

Weaknesses

- Two-sided marketplace cold start — employers need users, users need jobs.
- Show production is content-heavy and harder to scale than software.
- Founder-led sales bottlenecks will need to clear before Series A.
- Franchisee model introduces dependency on individuals.

Threats

- A large incumbent (LinkedIn, Indeed, Reed) launches an industry-first microsite.
- Diary of a CEO or similar launches a career-advice vertical with HDYD's playbook.
- Recession lengthens employer sales cycles.
- AI disrupts entry-level jobs faster than expected.
- Franchisee churn or reputational incident.

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Risks & Mitigations.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Cold-start two-sided market	High	High	Show-first audience strategy de-risks user side before employer sales scales
Underpriced employer tiers	Medium	Medium	Launch pricing for 12 months, then structured price uplift with NRR guardrails
Content production costs run hot	Medium	Medium	Free studio (FOX) Y1; AI-assisted editorial; franchisee content at zero cost Y1
Scraping IP / ToS pushback	Medium	Medium	Mix of scraped + direct-post + API partnerships; cease-and-desist protocol
GDPR / under-16 data	Low	High	Privacy-by-design; under-16 flow requires parental consent
Celebrity guest dependency	Medium	Low	Format works with credible operators + rising creators, not only A-listers
Key-person risk on founders	Medium	High	Founder vesting, key-person insurance from Series A
AI hallucination in profiles	Low	High	Strict zero-hallucination policy; human edit layer on all published profiles

Funding Strategy.

The £1.5m Seed Round

Raise size: £1.5m · **Structure:** SEIS (£250k) + EIS (£1.25m) · **Runway:** 21–24 months to Series A (Q3 2028) · **Valuation target:** £4.5–5.5m pre-money

Investor Targets

- **UK angel syndicates:** EIS-eligible syndicates focused on consumer, media and marketplaces
- **EIS funds:** Venerex, Octopus Ventures (EIS arm), SFC Capital, Haatch Ventures
- **Strategic corporate angels:** News Corp, Future plc, Global (Capital FM), LADbible, Reach plc — all with youth reach and potential distribution value
- **Recruitment strategics:** Adzuna, Reed, Indeed Ventures, SEEK Investments
- **Crowdfunding top-up:** Seedrs round of up to £150k to seal the round and build a fan base
- **Grants:** Innovate UK (AI / creative industries), DfE careers-skills grants, AI Opportunity Fund

Use of Funds (£1.5m over 21 months)

Category	£k	% of Raise	Detail
Team salaries & benefits	850	57%	7 hires over 21 months, including employer benefits
Content & podcast production	180	12%	Production costs at scale, guest fees, editorial commissions
Technology & hosting	90	6%	AI API (Gemini/OpenAI), hosting, data pipeline
Marketing & acquisition	180	12%	Paid social, events, PR, printed booklets

Office, admin, legal, finance	110	7%	SEIS/EIS, contracts, IP
Working capital buffer	90	6%	~6 weeks operating cost reserve
Total	**1,500**	**100%**	

Future Funding Path

- **2028:** Series A, £5–7m at 15–20x ARR, led by a consumer/marketplace VC
- **2030:** Series B, £15–25m, for US expansion and acquisitions
- **Exit horizon:** Strategic acquisition by recruitment incumbent (LinkedIn, SEEK, Recruit Holdings), media group (News Corp, Future, Global), or IPO (less likely before 2033)

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Financial Summary.

Full bottom-up model in HDYD_Financial_Model.xlsx. All figures in £ thousands unless stated.

P&L Summary

Line (£k)	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Revenue	165	920	3,250	7,900	15,400
Cost of revenue	46	202	618	1,343	2,464
Gross profit	119	718	2,632	6,557	12,936
Gross margin %	72%	78%	81%	83%	84%
Personnel	520	860	1,650	3,200	5,400
Marketing & acquisition	180	260	480	920	1,650
Other operating costs	99	118	292	537	1,036
EBITDA	**(680)**	**(520)**	**210**	**1,900**	**4,850**
EBITDA margin %	(412%)	(57%)	6%	24%	31%

Unit Economics (Employer Tier, Steady State)

Metric	Spotlight	Amplify	Partner
Annual contract value	£4,800	£14,400	£48,000
Gross margin %	86%	82%	74%
Blended CAC	£650	£2,100	£9,500

Payback (months)	2	3	6
Net revenue retention	96%	112%	125%
LTV / CAC (3-year)	**14x**	**10x**	**7x**

VALUES

What We Stand For.

HDYD is not just a product. It is a point of view. These are the values that shape every decision — product, editorial, hiring, and commercial.

Built with Gen Z. Built by them.

HDYD was conceived with young people and is being built with them at the table — not as a focus group, but as contributors, franchisees, hosts, editors and community leaders. We don't research Gen Z. We hire them. The product reflects that: it feels native because it is native.

Providing real jobs as we go.

25,694 live jobs on the platform today. We didn't wait to have the perfect product before making ourselves useful. Every day someone finds a job through HDYD. That's not a metric — it's the reason the company exists. Every product decision is weighed against a simple question: does this help someone find work?

Humans leveraging AI. Not the other way round.

AI makes HDYD possible at this scale — daily briefings, job matching, application tools, content curation. But the editorial voice, the show hosts, the franchisee expertise and the community are irreducibly human. We use AI to amplify human judgment, not replace it. In a world increasingly anxious about AI and work, that stance is both a product choice and a promise to our users.

Community over audience.

We are not building a passive audience. We are building a community of people who care about the same industries, who recognise each other at events, who introduce each other for jobs, who recommend HDYD because it actually helped them. Member-get-member growth is how the best communities scale — not advertising. The long-term value of a community compound in ways that an audience never does.

The metric we care about most: did someone find work they love?

Engagement, MAU, revenue — these matter. But the number we return to is simpler: how many people found an industry they love, a job they wanted, or a path they didn't know existed before they came to HDYD? That's the mission. Everything else is in service of it.

Vision.

The home of work curiosity.

HDYD is where you go when you want to know what it's actually like to work somewhere. Not a job board. Not a university prospectus. A curiosity engine — the one place that meets young people at the top of their thinking and walks them all the way to the job. The default destination for any 16–30 year old asking: what's next?

If we execute on the five-year plan, HDYD is generating £15m+ ARR across UK and US, covering 48 industries, running a magazine show network with tens of millions of annual listens, and sitting as the clear category leader in industry-first career media and recruitment.

The next chapter — beyond this plan — is international expansion across English-speaking markets and the launch of accreditation and learning products that turn HDYD into the destination you start your career at, before LinkedIn becomes the place you manage it.

Why Now

- AI is rewriting the entry-level labour market. Young people need an honest guide and traditional incumbents aren't shipping one.
- The creator economy has produced a generation of show talent cheaper and more reach-efficient than any TV or display ad.
- Employer branding budgets are rising while traditional careers-content consumption collapses.
- LinkedIn has drifted corporate, Indeed is commoditised, Reed is old-school. Whoever owns youth-native, industry-first career discovery in the next 24 months wins the category for a decade.

Curiosity may be the most valuable career skill of all.

The youth jobs crisis is real. The labour market has changed. Traditional entry routes have narrowed. But the future is not as bleak as the headlines suggest. There are opportunities flowing through the economy every day. The labour market is not a reservoir. It is a river. The challenge is helping more young people find the flow.

That's what HDYD is built to do.

— HOW DO YOU DO. THE HOME OF WORK CURIOSITY.

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